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Editors-in-Chief
Neural Processing Letters

Dear Editors,

We are pleased to submit the manuscript entitled *Pruning Deep Neural Networks via the Marchenko–Pastur Distribution* for consideration as a Letter-format submission to *Neural Processing Letters*.

The manuscript presents a concise main article on random-matrix-guided neural-network pruning. Its central contributions are a Marchenko–Pastur-driven pruning methodology, deterministic data-path certificates for mask pruning, and ImageNet-scale evidence for unstructured and structured sparsity under short post-pruning fine-tuning budgets. We believe this fits the journal’s emphasis on concise communications reporting methodological and theoretical advances in neural networks and machine learning.

To keep the main manuscript in Letter form, the submission separates the detailed material into two online resources. Online Resource 1 contains proofs and the mathematical supplement. Online Resource 2 contains methodology, reproducibility details, checkpoint and timing ledgers, and extended comparison tables. These online resources are supplied to support verification and reproducibility; they are not intended as independent companion articles.

The manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere. All authors have approved this submission and agree to be accountable for the work. The paper uses publicly available datasets and pretrained checkpoints; code, checkpoint provenance, and data-availability details are described in the manuscript and online resources.

In the present revision we applied small edits requested by careful citation/reproducibility readings of the package: a duplicate UniPTS bibliography entry was merged, the OWL reference was upgraded to its ICML/PMLR record, the size-trend figure caption in Online Resource 2 was clarified to make the sign convention of the regression fits unambiguous, the MaskLLM vision/4V row and the Pool–Yu fine-tuning column were re-labelled to match their source papers, a one-sentence note on artifact provenance (release manifest, SHA-256 status, ViT-L 8:16 row evidence trail) was added near the checkpoint URL in Online Resource 2, and the comparison-table preamble in the main manuscript was extended by one sentence stating that reference rows were checked against source-paper tables and that protocol-mismatched rows are included only as context. A short orthogonal-axes mention of recent binary-normalized networks was added to the related-literature paragraph in Online Resource 2; it is not a baseline. The float placement around the bibliography in Online Resource 2 was forced earlier with `\FloatBarrier/\clearpage` so that algorithm floats can no longer land inside the reference list. The scientific claims, tables of numbers, and theorem statements are unchanged.

Thank you for considering our submission.

Sincerely,

Yitzchak Shmalo
on behalf of the authors